

Tac & Lock — Field Manual

Version 1.0.0 · 2300AD Space Combat Simulator

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1. Overview

Tac & Lock is a browser-based Virtual Tabletop (VTT) tool for running **2300AD** space combat at the gaming table. It is GM-operated and designed for shared-screen play — one person drives, everyone watches.

Rules source: **2300AD Core Book 3: Vehicles and Spacecraft** pp.52–62 (primary). **Traveller 2022 Core Rulebook** is used only for internal critical hit tables (p.158–159) and weapon traits (p.75). Where B3 and CRB diverge, **B3 wins**.

Combat uses **range bands** — no hex grid, no velocity vectors. The seven bands (Adjacent → Distant) define all spatial relationships between ships. Ships spend TAC Speed to move between bands.

2. Dashboard

The Dashboard is the pre-battle lobby. Left panel: ship profiles. Right panel: operations console + tactical display.

2.1 Ship Profiles

Control	Action
+ NEW PROFILE	Create a new ship from scratch.
 Edit	Modify an existing profile.
 Duplicate	Clone a profile as a starting point.
 Delete	Remove a profile (confirmation required).
↓ IMPORT	Load profiles from a <code>.json</code> file.
↑ EXPORT	Save all profiles to a <code>.json</code> file.
 OFFICIAL CATALOG	Browse canonical 2300AD vessels and add them to profiles.

2.2 Operations Console

Control	Action
▶ ENTER BATTLE	Enter the battle screen (keeps existing roster).

Control	Action
↓ RESUME FROM FILE	Load a previously saved <code>.json</code> session. A preview shows the roster before you confirm.
 SAVE	Download the current session as <code>.json</code> .
CLEAR	Reset battle state (confirmation required).
 FIELD MANUAL	Opens this manual.

2.3 Ship Profile Form

Each profile stores the ship's combat statistics, weapons, sensors, computer, software, and crew.

Field	Notes
Name / Class	Display name and vessel class.
Hull Points	Maximum hull points.
Armour	Reduces incoming damage.
TAC Speed	Tactical Speed rating — how many band-change points the ship generates per round.
Signature	Base electromagnetic signature. Modified dynamically in battle.
Sensors	Type (Basic Military / Improved / Advanced) and DM bonus.
Computer	Model and bandwidth.
Weapons	Add weapon slots — choose from the canonical 2300AD weapon list.

Field	Notes
Software	Select installed software (Fire Control, Auto-Repair, etc.).
Crew	Named crew members with skill ratings (Tactics, Pilot, Engineer, Gunner, Electronics).

3. Phase Flow

Each combat round follows this sequence. The HUD shows the current round and phase. Click **NEXT PHASE** → to advance.

Phase	What happens
Setup	Add ships to the battle (right-click background → Add ship).
Initiative	Roll opposed Tactics(naval) check — order fixed for the engagement.
Manoeuvre	Each ship spends TAC Speed to approach or flee.
Attack	Each ship in initiative order fires weapons or launches missiles.
Actions	Each ship in initiative order performs one crew action.

At the end of Actions, the round counter increments and the sequence repeats from Manoeuvre.

4. Setup Phase

Right-click the background → **Add ship**. A modal opens:

Field	Notes
Profile	Which saved ship profile to use.
Faction	Players / NPC / Neutral — determines card colour coding.
Initial Range Band	The starting distance from all other ships (usually Long).

Ships are shown as bento cards grouped by faction. Each card shows hull bar, TAC Speed, armour, effective signature, weapons, critical tracks, and inbound missile ETA.

Right-click a card to open the context menu. Available actions depend on phase and initiative turn.

5. Initiative

Formula: $2D6 + \text{Tactics}(\text{naval}) + \text{INT DM}$ — opposed check. // B3 p.54

The Captain (or lead tactician) of each ship makes an opposed Tactics(naval) check. The ship with the highest total acts first. In case of a tie, re-roll. Initiative order is fixed for the entire engagement.

Surprise: a surprised ship cannot act in the first round.

How to Roll

Right-click background → **Roll Initiative**. The modal shows all ships.

Ship	Behaviour
Player ships	Enter your 2D6 physical dice in the two fields. Select Tactics skill level and INT DM.
NPC ships	Auto-rolled on confirm.
 button	Opt-in auto-roll for player ships.

6. Manoeuvre Step

Each ship in initiative order may spend TAC Speed to change range bands. // B3 p.52

Right-click a ship → **Manoeuvre...**

Control	Action
↓ APPROACH	Move toward the target ship (costs TAC Speed from the shared pool).
↑ FLEE	Move away from the target ship.
APPLY	Pool meets the band cost — band shifts, TAC Speed spent.
ALLOCATE	Pool below cost — TAC Speed allocated, band unchanged. Progress bar shows % toward next change.
GM SET	Override — sets the band directly with no TAC Speed cost. Use for initial placement.

TAC Speed **accumulates across rounds** within the same band pair. A ship that cannot cover the full cost in one round contributes partial thrust; the band changes when the pool is met.

Band Costs // B3 p.52

Band	Distance	TAC Speed cost
Adjacent	< 100 km	1
Close	≤ 150,000 km	1
Short	≤ 300,000 km	2
Medium	≤ 450,000 km	5
Long	≤ 600,000 km	10

Band	Distance	TAC Speed cost
Very Long	≤ 750,000 km	25
Distant	> 750,000 km	50

TAC Speed reserved for evasion is **not** spent here — it is declared as a reaction during the Attack Step.

7. Attack Step — Firing Solution

Each ship in initiative order may attack. The attack is a **3-step task chain** — each step's positive Effect carries forward as a DM to the next step. // B3 p.56

Right-click a ship → **Attack...**

Step 1 — Sensor Operator

Very Difficult (12+) Electronics (sensors) INT

DM source	Value
Target Signature	+Signature rating
Sensor quality	Basic Military +0 / Improved +1 / Advanced +2
Sensor Time-lag	Adjacent +1 / Close +0 / Short -1 / Medium -2 / Long -3 / Very Long -4 / Distant -5
Sensor Lock (active)	+sensorLockDm
Engineer assist	Routine (8+) Engineer(power) INT — adds Effect as DM

Step 2 — Pilot

Difficult (10+) Pilot DEX

DM source	Value
TAC Speed available	+tacSpeedAvailable
Engineer assist	Routine (8+) Engineer(power) INT
Effect from Step 1	Positive Effect carries forward

Step 3 — Gunner

Difficult (10+) Gunner INT — target number 10+

DM source	Value
Fire Control software	+1 per level (Fire Control/1 = +1, /2 = +2, /3 = +3)
Effect from Step 2	Positive Effect carries forward
EW jamming	ewEffect (negative, applied to attacker)
Sensor Lock	+sensorLockDm (applied on target)
Leading Fire	+leadingFireDm (Captain action this round)
Weapon trait Accurate	+1
Weapon trait Slow	-2
Evasion	evasionDm (negative, defender reaction)
Captain assist	Difficult (10+) Tactics(naval) INT

Hit = total ≥ 10. Effect = total – 10.

Stationary targets (reaction drive off, in orbit): DM+2, damage doubled. // B3 p.56

Damage

Weapon damage is rolled and reduced by the target's Armour (+ any active sandArmourBonus from Deploy Sand). Net damage is applied to Hull Points.

Weapon trait	Effect
Advanced	+1 damage per die
Obsolete	-1 damage per die
AP X	Ignores X points of Armour

8. Attack Step — Reactions

The defender can declare reactions before each attack roll.

Evasive Action

Declared before Step 3 (or at any reaction point). The defending ship spends **1 TAC Speed** to apply **DM–(Pilot skill + TAC Speed spent)** to the attack.

Point Defence

Declared against a missile salvo arriving at this ship. Gunner makes a **Difficult (10+) Gunner** check. On success, **Effect missiles** (min 1) are removed from the salvo. If count reaches 0, the salvo is destroyed.

Quinn Type 17 PDC has the **Point Defence** trait: DM+2 vs missiles, drones, and fighters.

Deploy Sand

Declared against a laser attack. **Automatic — no roll required.** Each sandcaster deployed adds **+1 Armour** against that one attack. The bonus is consumed immediately after the attack resolves.

9. Actions Step — Crew Actions

Each ship in initiative order may perform one crew action. Right-click a ship → **Crew Action...**

Select the action type, choose applicable target/options, roll (if required), then click **APPLY RESULT**.

Captain

Action	Check	Effect
Leading Fire	Average (8+) Tactics(naval) INT	All gunners on this ship gain DM+1 this round. Effect $\geq 4 \rightarrow$ DM+2. Resets at round end.

Engineer

Action	Check	Effect
Overload Stutterwarp	Difficult (10+) Engineer(stutterwarp) INT	Success: TAC Speed +1 this round. Failure: critical hit on Stutterwarp system.
Emergency Repair	Average (8+) Engineer INT/EDU	<i>System mode</i> : reduce one critical hit severity by 1. <i>Hull mode</i> : restore 1 Hull Point.

Sensor Operator

Action	Check	Effect
Sensor Lock	Average (8+) Electronics(sensors) INT	Target ship gains sensorLockDm = max(1, Effect). All attacks vs that ship gain this DM. Resets at round end.

Action	Check	Effect
Electronic Warfare	Average (8+) Electronics(countermeasures) INT	Jammed ship suffers DM=max(1, Effect) on all attacks. Resets at round end.
EW Countermeasures	Average (8+) Electronics(countermeasures) INT	Clears an active EW jam on this ship.
Active Sensors	Easy (6+) Electronics(sensors)	Activates active sensor sweep. Signature +1 while active (flag persists until toggled off in Ship Sheet).

Gunner

Action	Check	Effect
Point Defence	Difficult (10+) Gunner DEX	Pick an incoming salvo. Effect missiles (min 1) destroyed. Salvo removed if count = 0.
Deploy Sand	Automatic	Adds +1 sandArmourBonus to this ship. Applied vs the next incoming attack, then consumed.
Evasive Action	Automatic	Spend 1 TAC Speed → apply evasionDm to attacks this round.

Mechanic / Engineer

Action	Check	Effect
Damage Control	Average (8+) Mechanic INT/EDU	Pick an active hazard (fire, breach, fuel leak, radiation). Success removes it from the list. Effect

Action	Check	Effect
		≥ 4: hazard suppressed 1D rounds (GM narration).

Marines / Ship's Troops

Action	Check	Effect
Boarding Action	Average (8+) Gun Combat/Melee	Two-roll opposed resolution (see §12 Boarding).
Repel Boarders	Average (8+) Gun Combat/Melee	Defender's roll for boarding resolution (see §12 Boarding).

10. Critical Hits

Surface Fixture Damage // B3 p.58

Triggered on any hit with **Effect** ≥ 3, even if it does not penetrate armour.

Roll 2D on the Surface Fixture table:

2D	System	1st Hit	2nd Hit
2	Fire Control	DM-2 to attack rolls	—
3-4	Weapon	-1D damage, DM-2 to attacks	Disabled
5	Sensors	DM-2 to Electronics(sensors)	—
6-8	Radiator	See Radiator rules	—
9	Sensors	DM-2 to Electronics(sensors)	—
10-11	Discharge Vanes	Disabled	Destroyed

2D	System	1st Hit	2nd Hit
12	Other System	Disabled	Destroyed

Internal Critical Hits // B3 p.58 + CRB p.158–159

Triggered when the attack Effect is ≥ 6 , or when hull reaches 0.

Roll 2D for location (CRB p.158). 2300AD substitutions:

- **J-Drive** → **Stutterwarp Drive** (severity reduces TAC Speed by -1 per severity level)
- **M-Drive** → **Reaction Drive** (first crit: inoperable; second: destroyed)

Active Hazards

Some critical hits generate ongoing hazards (fire, hull breach, fuel leak, radiation exposure). The GM adds hazards via the **Ship Sheet** → **ACTIVE HAZARDS** panel. A successful **Damage Control** action removes one hazard.

11. Missiles

Launching

Right-click attacker → **Launch Missiles...** Select a target and salvo size (1–6 missiles).

The salvo enters the **Missile Tracker** with estimated rounds to impact (based on current range band). Each round the salvo advances one band closer to the target.

In-Flight Countermeasures

Method	Who	Effect
Point Defence (reaction)	Defender, Attack step	Gunner check — destroys Effect missiles (min 1) from an arriving salvo

Method	Who	Effect
Point Defence (crew action)	Defender, Actions step	Same mechanic — picks any in-flight salvo targeting this ship
Electronic Warfare	Sensor operator, Actions step	Increases target Signature (makes salvo easier to intercept); does not directly destroy missiles

Impact Resolution

When a salvo reaches Adjacent range, a ⚡ **MISSILE IMPACT** modal opens.

Roll 2D + attack DM vs 8+. On a hit, roll weapon damage – target Armour.

12. Boarding

Boarding resolves in **one opposed roll per round**, continuing until one side wins or retreats. Only at **Adjacent range** during the Actions Step.

Attacker's Roll (Boarding Action)

2D6 + Gun Combat/Melee + modifiers.

Defender's Roll (Repel Boarders)

2D6 + Gun Combat/Melee + modifiers.

Modifiers

Condition	DM
Superior armour	+1
Superior weapons	+1
Superior skill/tactics	+2

Condition	DM
Outnumber defender	+1
Vastly outnumber defender	+3
Defender without assigned marines	-2

Result Table (Attacker – Defender)

Difference	Result	Hull damage
-7 or less	Attackers defeated; defender may counter-attack DM+4	—
-4 to -6	Attackers defeated; must retreat or are captured	—
-1 to -3	Combat continues; defender DM+2 next round	2D Hull to defending ship
0	Combat continues; no advantage	—
1 to 3	Combat continues; attacker DM+2 next round	2D Hull to defending ship
4 to 6	Boarding succeeded; 2D rounds to pacify	1D Hull (ignores Armour)
7 or more	Immediate boarding; ship control passes to attackers	—

The GM applies the DM carry-over manually as a modifier in the next round's boarding roll.

13. Signature

Every ship has a base **Signature** value. Used as a positive DM in enemy Electronics(sensors) checks during the Firing Solution (Step 1). // B3 p.57

The effective Signature is computed dynamically — open the **Ship Sheet** to see the breakdown and toggle conditions.

Automatic Modifiers

Condition	Signature DM
Hull damage > 50%	+1
Power Plant critical hit	+1
EW active on this ship	+2

GM Toggles (Ship Sheet → Signature Conditions)

Condition	DM
Radiators Retracted	−1
Heat Sink Active	−4
Solar Panels Extended	+2
Spin Habitat Retracted	−1
Reaction Drive Active	+4 / +6 / +8 (rockets / thrusters / nuclear)
Active Sensors On	+1
Stealth system	−4

14. Undo / Redo

Every game state change pushes a snapshot to the undo stack (50-step maximum).

Control	Action
↶ Undo	Restore the previous state.
↷ Redo	Re-apply an undone action.

Both buttons appear in the HUD only when their stacks are non-empty. The battle log is not rolled back — an Undo entry is appended instead.

15. Save & Resume

Autosave

The app autosaves to IndexedDB after every significant action. On return, click  **RESUME** on the Dashboard to restore instantly.

Manual Save

Click  **SAVE** in the HUD to download the full session as a `.json` file.

Resume From File

On the Dashboard, click ↓ **RESUME FROM FILE** and select a `.json` file. A preview shows the full roster before you confirm loading.

Profile Export / Import

Ship profiles are independent from battle sessions. Use ↑ **EXPORT** and ↓ **IMPORT** in the profile panel to share or back up profiles separately.

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